

INTERVIEW EXPERIENCES ACROSS COMPANIES 26

This document is created to collect interview experiences from individuals who have gone through technical and HR interviews at various companies. Please feel free to share your experience to help others in their preparation.

Instructions for Contributors:

Please share your experience using the following format:

1. Company Name:
2. Interview Rounds: (e.g., Online Test, Technical Interviews, HR Interview)
3. Interview Process: (Describe the process and questions asked)
4. Preparation Tips: (Optional)
5. Additional Notes: (Optional)

GOOGLE:

Sumit De:

Debapriya Ghosh:

Irfan Habeeb Gazi:

Soumyadipto Pal

Brahmajit Ray

Sristi Dakua

Deepchika Bhutia

Vivek Halder

Syamantak Sengupta

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Aritra Maiti

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Atmik Goswami

Ankush Agarwal

Irfan Habeeb Gazi

Company Name: Google (SWE Intern)

Interview Rounds: One OA Round, followed by two Technical Interview Rounds

Interview Process:

OA Round: The OA consisted of 2 DSA questions and was conducted on HackerRank. The first question was based on dynamic programming on trees using sieve. The second question was an array question where you had to find the number of partitions in the array meeting some mentioned conditions, the question can be solved using maps.

I had solved the first question but wasted too much time on it. I was unable to write the optimal solution for the second question (TLE).

Technical Interview 1: The interviewer was conducted on Google Meet and we had to use Interview Docs, which is similar to Google Docs but with syntax highlighting for code.

The interviewer introduced herself and then asked for my introduction.

Then we moved to the DSA questions. The first question was fairly straightforward and was a variation of the Jump Game question on LeetCode. I was able to come-up with the solution and code it in 15 minutes. The interviewer then asked me a follow up question, where some additional restrictions were placed on what moves I can make. I solved this using backtracking. The interviewer seemed happy with my solution.

Finally, I was asked if I had any more questions and I asked her a bit about the internship process at Google and the projects we would get to work on.

Technical Interview 2: The interviewer directly jumped into the question in this one. The first question was similar to the Rain Water Trapping problem(1D array). But instead of rain there were fountains on some select buildings and we had to find which buildings were flooded. The question provided at start was a bit obscure and you were required to probe a bit to understand the complete question. I found an optimal solution using monotonic stack and difference array and coded up the solution. The interviewer then had a follow up question on this where we were given a 2D array of houses. I was stuck on this for a while, luckily the interviewer hinted me towards using graphs, and I was able to come up with the optimal solution using DFS.

Unfortunately, we were short of time by then, so I was just asked to dry run my DFS solution.

Overall, the interviewer seemed satisfied with the approach.

VERDICT: Selected

Preparation Tips: I strongly recommend being thorough with all basic DSA algorithms including Graphs and Dynamic Programming. Striver's A2Z Sheet and practicing on LeetCode should be sufficient for this. For all the questions in the Interview I was asked to dry run my code, so it is important to be comfortable with it.

Soumyadipto Pal

Company Name: Google(SWE Intern)

Rounds: Online Assessment, followed by 2 Technical Interview Rounds

Online Assessment:

The online assessment included two DSA questions, and I had 90 minutes to solve them. The first question was a medium-level problem where I had to optimize the cost of delivering goods to 'n' places based on some given conditions. This could be efficiently solved using two priority queues. I managed to get the correct solution for this one. The second question involved arrays and required finding the number of partitions in the array that meet certain conditions. The optimal solution involved using maps, but I couldn't figure it out in time, so I wrote a brute-force approach instead. This only got me partial credit.

Interview Round 1:

Both interview rounds were conducted over Google Meet, and we used a shared document for coding. My interviewer started by introducing herself, and then asked me to introduce myself. The first question was pretty straightforward: I was given a graph and asked to select a vertex that, when assigned as the root, would make the graph a binary tree. The second question was a follow-up to the first. This time, the edges of the graph were colored black or white, and I needed to select a root edge that would create a binary tree with alternating colors at each level (e.g., Level 1 is black, Level 2 is white, and so on). I was asked for the most optimized solution (in $O(N)$ time). After solving both problems, I was asked to explain the space and time complexity of my solutions.

Interview Round 2:

In the second interview round, I was asked to sort an array based on certain conditions, but I had to do it in less than $O(n \log n)$ time. This could be accomplished using a priority queue. The second question was about a tree where each edge had a value of either zero or one, representing water and land, respectively. I needed to find out the number of islands. For both questions, the interviewer asked me to do a dry run and explain the time and space complexity. Both problems were relatively easy, and the interview wrapped up in about 30 minutes.

Verdict: Selected

Preparation Tips: Practice all the basic DSA algorithms on graphs and trees. Learn the space and time complexity of the algorithms. Practice dry running your solutions. During the interview, interact with the interviewer and ask as many questions as possible. Think aloud while solving the problems, and try to explain your code as you write.

Brahmajit Ray

Company Name: Google(SWE Intern)

Rounds: Online Assessment, followed by 2 Technical Interview Rounds

Online Assessment:

The online assessment was of 90 minutes and had 2 DSA Questions. The first question was pretty close to LeetCode 1383(Maximum Performance of a Team) but was written in a confusing manner, so it took me some time to be able to map that problem to the problem that I had solved before. The second question was a question on strings and needed to find some partitions that met certain conditions. I was partially able to solve it with backtracking and ended up with a TLE.

Round 1:

All Interviews for Google were conducted over Google Meet. In the presentation we had been told that we would be assessed on only and only our DSA Skills, so that streamlined the preparation for the interview. With the interview link, a link to an Interview Doc was shared, which is in appearance very similar to the Python IDLE (has nothing other than syntax highlighting). The interviewer jumped straight to the question and said there is no point wasting 5-6 min in a high pressure interview introducing ourselves (I really liked this as Google is really stringent about the interview window). The question asked was a 2D matrix over which a sliding window approach with prefix sum had to be used. I wrote the code and was asked to dry run it. The interviewer was happy with the approach.

Round 2:

Ok, this is where the screw ups began for me. First of all, after my first round interview at around 4pm that day, I had not received any links or confirmation about my 2nd round interview. However at 3:30am (I luckily was up), I received a mail with an interview link and it was scheduled at 10am the next morning. The next morning, during the interview, the doc wouldn't open, neither for me nor the interviewer. Then, I probably faced what I would say to be the worst question on strings I have ever seen. For about 20 minutes, I absolutely had no clue about how to approach the problem. The interviewer himself acknowledged that it was a pretty tough problem and that he would give me extra time for that doc mishap and the overall difficulty of the problem. He started guiding me through the problem and then I somehow managed to drag myself to a $O(n^3)$ solution that I was able to further optimize to $O(n^2 \log n)$. I ran out of time and the interviewer then told me that the best solution was $O(n)$ but acknowledged that he himself did not expect it from a candidate, as it required a rather uncommon algorithm and was not at all intuitive and that he would be fine with $O(n^2)$.

Verdict: Not Selected

Brahmajit Ray

Company Name: Wells Fargo

Rounds: Online Assessment, followed by 1 Technical Interview Round, 1 HR Round

Online Assessment:

The online assessment had 4 separate sections: English, Data Interpretation and 2 DSA Section. During the presentation, there was no clarification about what exactly we would be asked in the OA, so we did not know what to expect. The English section predominantly focused on grammar and sentence construction. (I believe you cannot separately prepare for this section and have to rely on your instincts). The data interpretation section had a variety of graphs like candlestick graphs, histograms and so on. The first DSA section had 2 easy DSA questions. I solved the first one in under 2 minutes (Find the maximum in a 2D matrix) but the second question which was pretty easy also, refused to run completely. (The question was a direct copy of LC 2165, I came back home and wrote the same code and it passed). The last DSA section was a very tough section, only 10 minutes were allocated for this section and I could not solve this question completely.

Round 1:

The interviews for Wells Fargo were held offline in the TEQIP building. The first round interviews for Interns were scheduled after the FTE interviews and were to be of 30 minutes (at least that is what we were told). My interview slot was at 1:30pm but all of us were asked to report at 9:30am with the first FTE interviews starting at 10:00am. My interview initially slotted for 1:30pm started at 2pm because of a few technical glitches from either side (This round was online but we had to attend it from the TEQIP building). The interviewer was very friendly and we started off by introducing ourselves. The interviewer asked me for an overview of all my projects and I gave brief descriptions of all my projects. Then he switched over to technical questions from Java like JVM, ByteCode, Inheritance and a few questions from Python as Python and Java were the programming languages I had mentioned in my resume. Then he switched over to DBMS and asked about transactions, rollbacks, checkpoints, dirty read and quite a few SQL queries. Then I was asked a DSA question and this question was a direct copy of the 3Sum problem on LC. (But unfortunately, I had forgotten how to solve it). So I had to figure out the solution from scratch with a tiny hint from the interviewer and it took me about 30 min to solve the problem. The interviewer was overall happy with the proceedings and an interview initially slotted for 30 mins went on for 1hr 10 mins.

Round 2:

Just as I had left the interview room, I was told to be ready for my Round 2 interview in around 2 minutes time. I had just enough time to drink some water before I was called for my 2nd round interview. This interview was an in-person interview and I was interviewed by the Tech Lead of Wells Fargo India. I introduced myself and I was asked in detail about my projects and extensively interviewed on my ML knowledge. (Starting from Linear Regression to Decision Trees and ending at activation functions and optimizers). During my intro, I had mentioned that I

followed Formula1 and the next question I was asked was tricky: *“If Tesla introduces a team in F1 and they bring in driverless cars what would you have to keep in mind as the lead engineer at Tesla?”* followed by *“How would you feel about this change as a fan?”*. This discussion went on for about 15-20 mins and as time passed the discussion became more of a conversation than an interview. I felt good about the way the interview went and I was told that this was my last interview round as they had planned only 2 rounds for the Interns. This round lasted for 30–35 minutes for me though it was for about 15-20 mins for other FTE and Intern candidates.

Verdict: Selected

Tips: Wells Fargo, I felt focused a lot on communication and spoken English, so if you are not already good at it, please improve. Also be very careful about what you mention in your hobbies. Be versed with everything from CS Fundamentals to DSA as there was no fixed format in which questions were asked. (For eg someone was asked only DSA, someone only Fundamentals and some a mix of both)